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SUMMARY

Experienced program management professional with over five years of driving impactful initiatives across peace-building, civic space, human rights advocacy, and community development sectors proficient in project leadership, research and analysis, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and adept in communication and documentation. Passionate about human rights advocacy, peace and conflict studies, and addressing complex regional issues.

WORK EXPERIENCE

1. Project Officer (07/2021 – 11/2023)

Collective Campaign for Peace, Nepal

- **Enhanced Civic Space Monitoring and Dialogue:** Supported provincial and local governments in implementing peace-building initiatives by conducting civic space monitoring events in all 7 provinces, engaging an average of 90 participants per event, showcasing expertise in facilitating open dialogue and communication.
- **Human Rights Defender Support and Relocation:** Led the TIDES Foundation's "Civil Society Innovation Initiatives" project, overseeing the temporary relocation and support of Human Rights Defenders (HRDs) from Asian countries facing threats, demonstrating skills in crisis management and international coordination.
- **Research and Data Analysis on Civic Space:** Conducted extensive research on civic space across Nepal, designing and moderating Focus Group Discussions, developing research questions, and using tools like Mentimeter to present data, highlighting expertise in qualitative analysis and data visualization.
- **Capacity Building and Support for HRDs:** Coordinated a two-month initiative in Far-Western Nepal, providing strategic engagements, capacity-building, and psychosocial support to underprivileged HRDs, documenting challenges through case studies and organizing culturally enriching activities.
- **Support for Asylum Seekers and Journalists:** Led a three-month initiative for asylum seekers from Myanmar and a persecuted journalist from Bangladesh, facilitating protection, capacity-building, and integration into Nepal's civil society, showcasing skills in crisis management and legal advocacy.

- **Advocacy through Creative Arts:** Managed a three-month collaboration with Human Rights artists from Pakistan, enhancing their advocacy through creative arts and expanding their network within Nepal's civil society, gaining expertise in integrating arts into human rights work.
- **Collaboration with NHRC Nepal:** Collaborated extensively with the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) of Nepal on joint advocacy and policy discussions, deepening understanding of human rights challenges in South Asia and improving skills in policy analysis and stakeholder engagement.
- **Artivism Event Coordination:** Conducted an Art Exhibition and panel talk session titled "Artivism Unleashed: Exploring Human Rights through Art," hosting over 150 participants and highlighting skills in event management and artistic advocacy.
- **Workshops on Misinformation and AI:** Facilitated workshops on misinformation, disinformation, and AI impacts on civil society, assisting subject experts and trainers to educate, engage, and empower Human Rights Defenders.
- **Comprehensive Reporting and Partnership Management:** Prepared narrative reports, monthly and annual reports, and managed documentation and communication with government, NGOs, and international agencies, ensuring transparency and successful project delivery.
- **Administrative and Financial Coordination:** Developed a sound understanding of administrative and financial matters through close collaboration with Finance and Admin personnel, enabling effective independent or team-based handling of such issues.

2. Program Officer (09/2017–05/2020) Sansangai, Nepal

- **Secured Indigenous Rights in Lamjung:** Led an initiative to protect the rights of the Gurung community post-earthquake, focusing on sustainable livelihoods, advocating for their access to justice, and preventing their marginalization as generic victims.
- **Integrated Chepang Children into Education System:** Spearheaded efforts to rebuild schools and introduce skill-based education for the Indigenous Chepang community, ensuring their inclusion in mainstream education while respecting cultural heritage.
- **Enhanced Economic Opportunities for Tharu Community:** Facilitated skill-based training programs for the Tharu community in Bardiya, collaborating with local NGOs and government bodies to improve their economic standards and protect their economic rights.
- **Managed Community Development Projects:** Oversaw diverse initiatives including volunteer mobilization, reconstruction efforts, and community development, positively impacting over 1,000 individuals across five communities.
- **Led Earthquake Reconstruction in Lamjung:** Directed the reconstruction and rehabilitation project in Rainaskot Village, ensuring sustainable recovery for the affected community.
- **Promoted Sustainable Tourism:** Conducted baseline surveys and feasibility studies for the "Rainaskot Homestay" enterprise development project, leading to the successful establishment of homestay businesses through targeted training programs.
- **Mediated Between Stakeholders:** Acted as the focal contact and mediator among local government officials and politicians, facilitating consensus and cooperation in project implementation.
- **Advanced Livelihoods and WASH Practices:** Facilitated workshops on sustainable livelihood and WASH (Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene) practices for over 200 participants, enhancing their capacity to maintain a healthy living environment.
- **Led Emergency Humanitarian Response:** Spearheaded emergency responses to flood crises in Terai districts, coordinating efforts to deliver timely relief to affected populations.

- **Exhibited Expertise in Program Design:** Demonstrated proficiency in proposal writing, program designing, and management, contributing to the successful acquisition of funding and partnerships.
- **Monitored and Evaluated Projects:** Assisted in thorough monitoring and evaluation of projects, ensuring accountability and continuous improvement in program outcomes.
- **Enhanced Communication with Governments:** Led documentation, reporting, and communication strategies with local governments, ensuring transparency and effective dissemination of project results.
- **Secured Funding for Initiatives:** Led and assisted in preparing proposals and concept notes, successfully securing funds and partnerships to support various projects.

3. Program Assistant (07/2016–08/2017)

Youth Thinkers' Society, Nepal

- **Engagement in International Forums:** Assisted in preparing and implementing schemes to enable less privileged students from rural Nepal to participate in the Everest International Model United Nations (EIMUN) sessions. This involved comprehensive administrative and logistical support, drafting project proposals and MOUs, and conducting baseline research, enhancing the inclusion and representation of marginalized youth in global human rights and development discussions.
- **Supported Capacity Building Initiatives:** Provided administrative and logistical support for various events and capacity development programs, ensuring effective implementation and impactful results in youth and development sectors.
- **Developed Strategic Documentation:** Assisted in preparing project proposals, concept notes, MOUs, and baseline research documents, Contributing to the successful planning and execution of key initiatives and fostering partnerships.
- **Organized and Executed International Programs:** Played a key role in organizing the Everest International Model United Nations (EIMUN) and led the setup of an International Youth Exchange program, promoting cross-cultural dialogue and leadership among young participants.
- **Researched and Reported on Development Issues:** Conducted research and drafted reports on youth and development-related issues, providing valuable insights and recommendations for evidence-based program development and advocacy.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

- **Collective Campaign for Peace (Project Officer):** Led the "Civic Space Innovation Initiatives" project, collaborating with experts across various fields. Conducted monitoring and consultation events in all seven provinces, developed and moderated Focus Group Discussions (FGDs), and performed thematic analysis for qualitative data using SPSS. Drafted research questions, transcribed discussions, developed codes, identified themes, and interpreted findings. Collected participants' ratings on civic space status and visualized data using Mentimeter.
- **Sansangai (Program Officer):** Conducted baseline surveys and feasibility studies for the "Rainaskot Homestay, Lamjung" project. Utilized FGDs, surveys, and Key Informant Interviews (KIIs) to assess feasibility and needs. Contributed to the reconstruction of Rainaskot village post-2015 earthquake, focusing on economic sustainability through homestay enterprises.

- **Youth Thinkers' Society (Program Associate):** Conducted desk research and gathered secondary data for multiple projects. Assisted in planning the Everest International Model United Nations (EIMUN) with the US Embassy Nepal. Participated in an international student exchange program, developing concept notes and researching community engagement strategies for Japanese students in rural Nepal.
- **Academic Research:** Conducted thesis research titled "A Study on the Causes of Brain Drain among Undergraduate Students of Biratnagar Metropolitan City" using descriptive research design and qualitative data collection. Conducted a field study report titled "A Study on the Functioning of Local Judicial Council at Resunga Municipality and Isma Rural Municipality of Gulmi Districts" as part of the academic curriculum.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

- **Master of Arts in Conflict, Peace and Development Studies** (2018 – 2020)
Department of Conflict, Peace and Development Studies, Tribhuvan University
- **Master of Arts in Political Science** (2018 – 2020)
Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences, Tribhuvan University
- **Bachelor of Arts in Social Work and English Literature** (2014 - 2017)
St. Xavier's College, Kathmandu, Tribhuvan University

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAININGS

- Introduction to Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific, ADB Institute (04/04/2020)
- Integrity in Academic writing, St. Xavier's College (02/09/2016)
- Beginner-level workshop for Adobe Photoshop, Youth Thinkers' Society (12/08/2015)

VOLUNTEERING EXPERIENCES

- **Facilitated Medical Outreach:** Organized and moderated a two-day medical camp for brick kiln workers in Bhaktapur, providing essential health services and education with support from JRM Foundation USA.
- **Enhanced Healthcare Access:** Translated and interpreted for international medical teams in Lalitpur and Nuwakot, improving healthcare delivery in underserved slum areas.
- **Supported MBBS Foundation Network Expansion:** Volunteered to strengthen the network and capacity of the Maina Bal Bikash Samiti (MBBS) Foundation, dedicated to honoring Maina Sunuwar's legacy and advocating for justice and support for conflict-affected individuals. Engaged in activities to enhance the foundation's impact and reach.
- **Ensured Electoral Integrity:** Oversaw the electoral process as an Election Invigilator during the Nepal Election 2017, ensuring fairness and transparency.
- **Promoted Inclusive Education:** Taught Social Studies and Moral Education as an Academic Trainee at Guheswori School, fostering inclusive values.
- **Supported Disability Research:** Interpreted for PhD students researching disabled professionals in Nepal, aiding in the inclusion of differently-abled individuals.
- **Facilitated Rehabilitation Sessions:** Conducted roleplay and input sessions at Clear Vision Rehabilitation Centre, supporting rehabilitation and community integration.

REFERENCES

Mr. Mahesh Bhatta

Director

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Collective Campaign for Peace (COCAP),
Kathmandu, Nepal

Ms. Natasha Wozniak

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